



An introduction to the ANCR Extension for ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023

A receipt for every privacy notice

How Kantara's consent receipt led to ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023, what the ANCR extension adds, and how you can take part

September 2026



At a glance



You get a receipt for a coffee. For your personal data you usually get a banner and a button. After the click, you have nothing to indicate what you were told, who told you, or what you agreed to. Only the organisation holds the record.

The consent receipt was written at the Kantara Initiative to change that. The work began in 2009, in the first work group Kantara launched. It became the Consent Receipt Specification v1.1 in 2018. ISO included this receipt work in ISO/IEC 29184:2020, *Online privacy notices and consent* and based ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023, Consent record information structure on it.

TTS 27560 defines the fields in a consent record and a receipt. However, it did not specify how a person gets a receipt, how they keep it, and what information they can check before they are identified by an organisation online.

The Kantara Anchored Notice and Consent Receipt (ANCR) Work Group is writing that part now, as the ANCR Extension for ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023. The v1.0 Release Candidate, Release 1, was announced on 7 September 2026.

This brochure tells the history, sets out what the extension adds, and shows where your help is needed in the ANCR work group.

ANCR gives people a receipt for every privacy notice and gives regulators evidence they can check.

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Highlights, 2009 to 2026



Kantara's first work group The Information Sharing Work Group starts work on how people share personal information.	2009	
	2012	Three questions The Standard Information Sharing Label asks who is asking, where the data will go and how to reach them. Open Notice joins the group.
Consent Receipt v1.1 Published after public review and a member ballot. Six vendors build an interoperability demo.	2018	
	2020	Into ISO ISO/IEC 29184:2020 includes the receipt as an annex example. SC27/WG5 takes it up as the basis for 27560.
ANCR Work Group launches 28 January, Data Privacy Day.	2021	
	2023	ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023 Published on 8 August. Now free to access from ISO.
Transparency Performance Indicators A Kantara Initiative Recommendation since August.	2025	
	2026	ANCR Extension v1.0 Release Candidate Release 1, 7 September.

1. How a Kantara receipt became an ISO specification



1.1 Three questions, 2009 to 2012

In September 2009, a Kantara group working on personal information renamed itself the Information Sharing Work Group. This was the first Kantara working group.

By 2012, the group had built a Standard Information Sharing Label, funded in part through Kickstarter, with the code on GitHub. The label asked three things:

Who is asking?

Where will my data go?

How do I reach them?

That same year, the Open Notice Initiative presented a call for collaboration at the W3C Do Not Track and Beyond workshop, and its participants joined the group. The consent work started there. The Controller Identification Record in the 2026 extension covers the same three questions.

1.2 The consent receipt

The Minimum Viable Consent Receipt reached v0.5 in November 2014. In 2016, the group described the receipt to the Canadian privacy commissioner as the equivalent of a store receipt, because both sides hold a record.

Version 1.1 went through a 45-day IPR review, three rounds of public comment, a work group ballot and an all-member ballot. It used ISO/IEC 29100 vocabulary so that one receipt could line up with notice rules in many countries. The release was timed with the GDPR on 25 May 2018.

In August 2018, six vendors (Consentua, digi.me, iWelcome, Trunomi, Ubisecure and UNLOQ) built an interoperability demo for MyData 2018. It showed receipts passed between organisations and read correctly.

1.3 Into ISO

ISO/IEC 29184:2020, Online privacy notices and consent, includes Consent Receipt v1.1 as an annex example.

In April 2020, ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 27/WG5 took up the consent receipt as the basis for a consent record information structure. That project became ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023, published on 8 August 2023. ISO now makes the TS free to access.

The TS is referenced in European Digital Identity Wallet standards work at CEN. A paper on implementing it won Best Paper at the ENISA Annual Privacy Forum in 2024.

The consent receipt in ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023 began as a Kantara specification.

1.4 What the TS leaves open

TS 27560 is a structure for information. Its introduction says that it does not specify an exchange protocol for records or receipts. The W3C guide to the TS notes that it does not describe how people obtain receipts or keep their own records.

- **Delivery.** The TS does not say how a receipt gets from the controller to the person, or how the person or a regulator can check it later.
- **Identification comes first.** The record header requires a PII principal identifier, so a record starts once a person is identified. Notice given before identification has no record of its own.
- **Consent only.** The lawful basis field is optional and its value has to relate to consent. Notice given under other legal bases sits outside the record.
- **Integrity is optional.** The controller decides what goes in the receipt, and integrity controls are described as something a receipt may include.

The TS only defines what a consent record contains. How the record reaches the person, and how anyone checks it, is left to other specifications.

1.5 Why this matters now

Laws put the burden of proof on the organisation. Under the GDPR, the controller has to be able to show that consent was given and must give clear information when data is collected. Convention 108+ sets a similar transparency duty.

Recent events add pressure. The transparency duties in Article 50 of the EU AI Act began to apply on 2 August 2026. The European Commission's Digital Omnibus proposal of November 2025 would make browser privacy signals binding on controllers. A signal says what the person wants. Something still has to record what the controller disclosed and did.

In May 2026, the Council of Europe lead panel at the CPDP conference in Brussels that highlighted the importance of operational transparency and “notification before identification” as its subject. Panelists included privacy leaders from the Council of Europe’s Committee of Convention 108, United Nations and ISO/IEC JTC1/SC27/WG5.

Digital systems must be “architected to prove their compliance and accountability at the very first point of interaction”.

UN Special Rapporteur on the Right to Privacy, CPDP, 20 May 2026, as reported by the Council of Europe



2. What the ANCR extension adds



The ANCR Extension for ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023 is a Kantara specification, open and royalty-free. It keeps the TS fields and adds the records needed to show that notice was given, which version was shown, and who is accountable, before the person is identified. The current text is the v1.0 Release Candidate, Release 1, dated 7 September 2026. It is in review at the work group and is intended as a Kantara contribution to ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 27/WG 5.

2.1 The records

Record	What it does
Controller Identification Record (CIR)	Says who is accountable and how to reach them. It is published, so anyone can read it without an account.
Notice Record	The controller's standing record of a notice: purposes, legal basis, rights and the contact point.
Notice Version Object	Fixes one version of a notice with a SHA-256 hash over the exact text, so a receipt can be matched to what was shown.
Notice Receipt and Anchored Notice Receipt	The person's copy. It names the controller record, the notice, the version and the time of presentation. No personal identifier is required.
Authorization State Object	One object that holds the state of each purpose and whether the record is still valid, wherever that state is relied on.
Notice Event Log	An open to access log of notice events, kept separately from records of processing.

2009

work begins in Kantara's first work group

6

vendors built the 2018 interoperability demo

8

conformance criteria in the extension, C1 to C8

12

mandatory requirements in clause 8

A person can receive proof of notice without giving an identifier.

2.2 Conformance

The extension sets eight conformance criteria for digital privacy in clause 5.1:

- C1 sequence
- C2 minimum notice disclosure
- C3 anonymity by default
- C4 public rule reference
- C5 evidence
- C6 reciprocal and proportionate disclosure
- C7 non-exclusion
- C8 authorization state

Clause 8 lists twelve mandatory requirements. Conformance is asserted for each notice version. When the notice changes, the claim has to be made again.

2.3 How conformance is measured

A specification states what conforming looks like. It does not say how conformance is determined, by whom, or on what evidence. The Transparency Performance Indicators supply that part.

Transparency Performance Indicators: PII Controller Identification for Valid Consent is a Kantara Initiative Recommendation, adopted in August 2025 after public comment from March to May that year. It measures what a controller actually publishes against rated indicators: controller identification, notice accessibility, and the security transparency of the certificate or key presented at the point of notice.

The result is a figure rather than an assertion. A supervisory authority, a relying party or an individual can compare one controller against another, and the same controller over time, which is what a performance indicator is for and what a conformance clause on its own cannot give.

The Recommendation is adopted. The extension is a release candidate in review. So the measurement instrument is in place before the specification it measures is finished, which is the opposite of the usual order and is why conformance can be tested from the first pilot.

The indicators were published independently as Transparency Performance Indicators (TPIs) at the 2025 IEEE Symposium on Privacy Expectations, IEEE Xplore, DOI 10.1109/ISoPE67098.2025.00019.

2.4 Staying aligned with the TS

Annex A maps the extension to ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023. There is one declared deviation: the PII principal identifier is not required, and an optional account identifier takes its place. Receipts carry the schema identifier ancr-notice-receipt-2.0.

The point is an old one. In August 2022 the work group told ISO, through the Kantara liaison, that a consent record should not expose the person's identifier.

2.4 Optional parts

Annex B holds two optional profiles, one for a PII processing record and one for a personal data control record. Annex C gives a lawful basis vocabulary that includes the value "unresolved". Annex D describes a four stage exchange. Annex E gives a profile for Transparency Performance Indicator reporting, with no composite score.

2.5 What an Anchored Notice Receipt carries

The field names below are the ones used in Release 1.
The notes in brackets say what each field is for.

```
schema_version
ancr-notice-receipt-2.0

receipt_id
(unique reference for this receipt)

notice_id
(the notice that was shown)

notice_version_reference
(hash of the exact version shown)

controller_identification_record_id
(who is accountable)

presented_at
(time the notice was presented)

notice_type
(kind of notice)

pii_principal_id
not required

account_id
optional
```

2.6 Transparency Performance Indicators

The work group also publishes the Transparency Performance Indicators, a Kantara Initiative Recommendation since August 2025. Four indicators show how transparent a service is before a person gives it anything: when the notice appears, what it says, whether the person can reach and use it, and whether the authority and security behind it check out.

The indicators can be applied from outside the service. They never require the person to be identified.

3. Co-Regulated Digital Identity



3.1 What CRDI means

Co-Regulated Digital Identity (CRDI) is the name for the approach the extension puts into practice. Two sets of rules apply to a digital identity + Identification relationship at the same time: the organisation's own rules, and the public rules of treaty, law and standards. Under CRDI both are written into records that anyone can inspect.

- The controller is identified first, through the Controller Identification Record.
- The notice is fixed by version and hash.
- The person receives a receipt without having to be identified.
- Identity stays with the person. Identifying someone is an act the controller has to account for.
- Consent is a decision people make. Permissions are what systems manage. The records keep the two apart.

Know who is asking before they know who you are.

3.2 How it fits with other work

Global Privacy Control and Advanced Data Protection Control carry the person's choice. IEEE 7012 MyTerms, published in January 2026, carries the person's terms. The W3C Data Privacy Vocabulary supplies terms that can be used inside the records. ANCR records what the controller disclosed and what happened.

The extension works with any identity protocol. It needs no blockchain and no wallet. And it uses only open and free to access international standards.

3.3 Legal footing

EDPB *Guidelines 05/2020 on consent* say a controller does not have to collect extra information to identify someone only to comply. The Article 29 Working Party transparency guidelines say the first layer of a notice should be purpose specific, the identity and authority of the controller as well as the person's rights, and that online transparency applies whatever the legal basis.

The Transparency Performance Indicators map to Convention 108+ and to GDPR Article 30.



4. Why the work sits in Kantara



4.1 Open drafts and open comment

Kantara work group drafts are public. The ANCR drafts, the change log and the release packages are on GitHub, and anyone can read them and comment.

ISO texts are developed by national bodies and liaison organisations. Many people who build consent tools never see an ISO draft.

4.2 A record of open process

The work has run in the open for seventeen years. Consent Receipt v1.1 passed an IPR review, three public comment rounds and a member ballot. The Transparency Performance Indicators went through public comment from March to May 2025 before becoming a Recommendation.

4.3 Progress in 2026

During 2026 the extension went through several public drafts and reached a v1.0 release candidate on 7 September. Work group calls moved to twice a month in August.

4.4 A route into ISO

Kantara holds a liaison with ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 27/WG 5. Work that matures in Kantara can be offered to ISO through that liaison. The consent receipt took that route. The extension is intended as a liaison contribution in the same way.

4.5 What Kantara can carry next

Several capabilities fall outside a TS that defines an information structure. They can be developed in Kantara:

- machine readable schemas for each record
- test procedures for criteria C1 to C8, and a conformance programme
- an integrity mechanism for receipts issued without an identifier
- later stages of exchange, such as credentials and tokens, which the release candidate describes in an informative annex only

Building this digital infrastructure for people depends on work outside ISO for the delivery, checking and testing of receipts. That work is happening in Kantara.

5. What it means for you



Regulators

ANCR gives you records to audit: a controller identification record, a hashed notice version, a receipt held by the individual and an event log. Each can be checked against the others. Conformance is asserted per notice version, which suits a sandbox.

Controllers, DPOs and privacy engineers

You already have to show what people were told. ANCR is a standard way to keep that evidence. Publish a controller identification record, version your notice, issue a receipt without requiring identification, and keep an event log.

Wallet providers and identity vendors

A wallet shares attributes. The holder also needs a record of who received them and under what notice. ANCR supplies it in a TS 27560 structure and does not depend on a credential format.

Standards participants

An extension profile of TS 27560:2023 with one declared deviation and a clause mapping. It covers what the TS left out of scope: exchange, how the individual obtains and keeps a receipt, and controller identification.

Individuals and civil society

You keep the receipt. It names who is responsible and how to reach them, even if their record disappears. You do not have to be identified to get it.

AI governance teams

Hashed notice versions and an authorization state that can be reconstructed give a dated answer to the question: what was this person told, and what had they agreed to, when this data was used?

Questions people ask

Is this a consent management platform?

No. It is a record format with rules for evidence. A consent management platform could produce ANCR records.

Is it only about consent?

No. The notice receipt applies whatever the legal basis, which matches regulator guidance that transparency applies whatever the legal basis.

Does it need a blockchain or a wallet?

No.

Why build on the 2023 TS while ISO is revising it?

The 2023 TS is published, stable and free to access. The revision is a committee draft with a new title and scope.

Is it finished?

The extension is a release candidate in review. The Transparency Performance Indicators document is a full Kantara Recommendation.

6. Take part



6.1 Who is needed

- Organisations that give notice and collect consent, to pilot a Controller Identification Record and a notice receipt.
- Builders of consent tools and wallets, and privacy engineering teams, to write schemas and reference code.
- Lawyers, data protection officers and regulator staff, to test the records against legal duties.
- Standards experts, to keep the extension and the ISO texts aligned.
- Researchers and designers, to test whether people can read and use a receipt.

6.2 Work that is open now

- Review Release 1 and send comments.
- Write the JSON schemas.
- Draft the conformance test procedures.
- Propose the integrity mechanism for anonymous receipts.
- Bring a use case from your sector.

6.3 How to join

1. Read Release 1 in the GitHub repository.
2. Open the ANCR Work Group page on the Kantara wiki and choose Join.
3. Sign the Group Participation Agreement. Kantara membership is not required to take part in a work group.
4. Subscribe to the mailing list and come to a call. Calls run twice a month.

Every record in the extension still needs schemas, tests and pilots. Each of those is a piece of work one person or one team can pick up.

6.4 Links

ANCR Work Group wiki

kantara.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/WA/overview

GitHub repository

github.com/KantaraInitiative/ancr-wg



About the work group

The Anchored Notice and Consent Receipt (ANCR) Work Group at the Kantara Initiative continues open work on information sharing and consent that began in Kantara's first work group in 2009. That work produced the Kantara Consent Receipt Specification v1.1 (2018), was included in ISO/IEC 29184:2020, and is the basis of ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023. The work group publishes the Transparency Performance Indicators Recommendation (2025) and is developing the ANCR Extension for ISO/IEC TS 27560:2023, an open, royalty free specification for Co-Regulated Digital Identity (CRDI).

ANCR Work Group wiki

kantara.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/WA/overview

GitHub repository

github.com/KantaraInitiative/ancr-wg